



In-flight games

Finally, at long last, the FAA seems to be close to a ruling that will allow the use of electronic in-flight <http://dgit.in/18mkaZo>

Pilotless warfare

The most awesome remote-control aircraft in the world is now this full-fledged F-16 fighter plane. <http://dgit.in/18Ufuq3>

Q&A

behave erratically. Re-installing drivers may fix the issue.

- If you're still facing the same problem, check if you have any system downloads running in the background, such as Windows updates for example, or some other software which may be updating itself.
- If you have an external antenna in your PC for the WiFi connection, make sure the antenna is connected properly.

After performing all of the above, if you're still having the same trouble, call your ISP and tell them to send in a guy to help fix this issue. If it still doesn't work out then write back to us again with details on the steps you did and we'll try to help.

Noisy, overheating laptop

I own an HP 630 Notebook with the following configuration:

- Processor- Intel Core i3 370M @2.40Ghz;
- RAM - 2GB DDR3;
- HDD - 500 GB;
- Graphics- Intel HD Graphics;

I have been using it for over two years now, but from the past few days I am experiencing some heating issues with it. Within a usage of hardly 15 minutes, it heats up to such a level as if it's being used continuously for more than three hours or so. The internal fan keeps on rotating at very high RPMs and makes a lot of sound which is very irritating. I don't use the laptop for gaming or watching movies, but only some basic tasks like word processing, internet surfing etc. What is the possible reason for this overheating? What steps should I take to stop this? Please advise me soon as I am very much worried about my laptop.

Prateek Mathur

A Laptop overheating is one of the most common problems that arise after prolonged usage of any laptop. The main cause of overheating is usually dust that blocks the intake grills or exhaust ports. Dust gets inside the laptop and clogs the fan, because of which the fan starts making noises. Heat builds up inside the laptop and to counter this, the fan starts spinning much faster and generates even more noise. Sometimes, the thermal paste between the heatsink and the CPU dries up thereby directly increasing the internal temperatures.

If your laptop is still under warranty, then have it serviced through the respective service centre. If not, you'll have to clean the laptop from the inside yourself. Consult your laptop's user manual and open up the laptop to clean the heatsink and fans inside. Take a dry and soft piece of cloth to clean components inside. Use a small paint brush to clean areas that are very small and are hard to reach using a cloth. You can also use a readily available can of compressed air and blow it on dusty areas to quickly get rid of dust. Next, clean the residue of the old, dried-up thermal paste by using a swab of cotton slightly dipped in Isopropyl alcohol and wipe it off. Apply a new coat of thermal paste to the CPU and reinstall the heatsink. Once you're done, your laptop shouldn't be overheating any more.

Also, investing in a laptop cooler should also help. Note that if you're still having over-heating issues despite checking

all of the above, it's possible that you have a faulty component somewhere and your laptop will need a thorough check-up from a professional service centre.

Low on RAM

My PC configuration is as follows:

- Processor - Intel Dual Core 1.8GHz;
- Motherboard - Gigabyte 945;
- Seagate - 160GB HDD;
- RAM - Dynet 1GB DDR3;
- PSU - 450 Watts.

When I open multiple tabs in Google Chrome or when I run multiple applications together, the RAM usage goes to 95% and PC slows down. Please let me know if I need to upgrade my pc.

Ninad m.g

A Yes, you are having a shortage of RAM on your PC. Since your PC config is very dated, what you really need is a complete system overhaul. That said, just bumping up your RAM to 2GB or 4GB should drastically improve your computing experience. An entry-level GPU such as the GTX620 will also do wonders for your system. **d**



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